

FINEBOY PRODUCER PRESENTS



THE QUICK NO-FLUFF PROMO GUIDE

*A full, easy-to-understand plan for growing your music — for independent artists
who want strategy before streams.*

9

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REAL STORIES

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FLUFF

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00 WHY THIS GUIDE EXISTS

Getting people to hear your music is hard. Most guides make it feel even harder — big words, long chapters, confusing charts.

This one is different. Every idea here is written in plain, everyday words, so it is easy to follow no matter your experience level. Nothing here is fluff, and nothing here is filler. It is what works, why it works, and real stories of artists who used these exact ideas to grow.

This guide covers everything you need — from setting up your profile, to releasing music the smart way, to getting on playlists, to winning on social media, to building real fans, to reading your numbers. Read it once fully. Then come back to single chapters before every release.

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WHO THIS IS FOR

- Independent artists releasing music without a label
- Artists with music out already who haven't broken through yet
- Producers and songwriters who want to understand promotion too
- Anyone who wants a real plan — not vague social media advice

01 SET UP YOUR PROFILE RIGHT

Before you promote a single song, make sure your online home looks right.

Think of your Spotify and Apple Music profile like the front of a shop. A messy front, people walk past. A clean, exciting front, people walk in. Do this work once, properly, and every release after this becomes easier.

YOUR SPOTIFY FOR ARTISTS CHECKLIST

- Claim your official profile at artists.spotify.com — this is step one, and it is free
- Upload one big, clear photo of yourself — sharp and well lit, not blurry or cropped from an old photo
- Write a short bio that says who you are, where you're from, and what you sound like
- Add your Instagram, TikTok, website, and booking contact
- Pin your favorite or newest song to the top of your profile
- Build your own playlist showing the artists who inspire your sound
- Submit every new song for playlist consideration at least 7 days before it drops

APPLE MUSIC AND AMAZON MUSIC

Claim your artist profile on Apple Music for Artists and Amazon Music for Artists too. Both are free, both give you useful data about your listeners, and both have their own editorial teams looking for new music. Use the same photo, bio, and links you used on Spotify, so your brand looks the same everywhere.

THINK LONG-TERM

Growing on streaming is more like planting a garden than buying a lottery ticket. Every release builds on the last, and every fan you earn today helps the next song travel further. Stay patient and stay consistent.

02 PLAN YOUR RELEASE

Artists who upload a song and hope for the best rarely break through. Artists who build excitement *before* release day do much better — because streaming platforms watch closely how a song performs in its very first days.

HOW OFTEN TO RELEASE

- Singles — every 6 to 10 weeks keeps you visible without rushing your quality
- An EP — every 6 to 9 months, once you have 4 to 6 songs that belong together
- An album — once a year at most, and only once you have a real audience to bring to it

THE PRE-SAVE: YOUR MOST USEFUL TOOL

A pre-save lets a fan click a link before your song comes out. The moment it drops, it lands straight in their library — no searching required. This matters because streaming platforms track how fast people listen in the first few days. A quick rush of listens tells the platform: people like this, show it to more people.

REAL STORY

An independent act called Kids of the Apocalypse ran a simple pre-save campaign for one single. It brought in hundreds of pre-saves before the song even dropped — and that early wave of support helped push the track to 26,000 streams in its first few weeks.

YOUR SIMPLE RELEASE TIMELINE

- 2–3 weeks before: share your pre-save link everywhere — your bio, your stories, your posts
- The final week: post a short snippet of the song and remind people to pre-save
- Release day: post on every platform, message your most supportive fans directly, go live if you can
- The week after: keep posting and thank the people who streamed it — don't disappear once it's out
- Weeks after that: start teasing whatever is coming next

Free tools for building a pre-save link: DistroKid's HyperFollow, Linkfire, and Feature.fm.

03 GET FOUND ON PLAYLISTS

Playlists are one of the biggest ways people discover new music. There are two kinds, and they work differently.

Big official playlists

Run by Spotify's own team. Hard to get on. Massive reach when you do. Pitch these free through Spotify for Artists at least 7 days before release.

Independent playlists

Run by regular people or small pages. Easier to get on. Still send you real, engaged listeners.

HOW TO WRITE A PITCH THAT GETS READ

Curators receive hundreds of pitches. A short, genuine one stands out far more than a long, generic one. Keep yours under 150 words, and always include these five things:

- A real compliment about their playlist — show you actually listened to it
- Who you are, in one sentence — your name, your genre, where you're from
- What your song sounds like, in two sentences
- Why it fits their playlist specifically
- One clean link to the song

SIMPLE PITCH TEMPLATE

Hi [Curator Name], I've been enjoying [Playlist Name] — especially how you mix [something specific about it].

I'm [Your Name], a [genre] artist from [location]. My new song "[Song Title]" just came out. It's a [mood] track that feels like [Reference Artist].

I think it would sit well on your playlist. Here's the link: [URL]. Thanks for listening either way!

WHERE TO FIND CURATORS

- SubmitHub and Groover — submission platforms with curator databases
- Search your genre plus the word "playlist" on Spotify, or hashtags like #playlistcurator
- If you don't hear back, send one short follow-up after a week, then move on — never pressure a curator

04 WIN ON SOCIAL MEDIA

For independent artists — especially in Afrobeats and Amapiano — TikTok is the single biggest free door to getting discovered. It does not matter how many followers you have. What matters is whether people want to use your sound in their own videos.

REAL STORIES

CKay's "Love Nwantiti" was already two years old when it suddenly went viral on TikTok in 2021. It ended up charting in eight countries and going platinum in the US.

Producer Pheelz posted one short clip of himself dancing to his beat "Finesse" in the studio. That clip sparked a huge TikTok dance trend, and the song became the most Shazamed track in the world within days.

Rema's "Calm Down" spread through TikTok before it ever became a Billboard hit with Selena Gomez.

None of these artists paid for ads. They posted short, honest clips and let people share them.

WHAT TO ACTUALLY POST

- A clip of you reacting to your own song
- A short "behind the scenes" moment from the studio
- A simple dance or moment tied to the best 15 seconds of your song
- The real story behind why you made the song

INSTAGRAM REELS AND YOUTUBE SHORTS

Reels reward polish more than TikTok does — good lighting and a clean look help. Shorts have a longer shelf life, so a good Short can still get views months later. The easiest way to use all three: film once, then post the same clip to TikTok, Reels, and Shorts.

The rule that matters most: post often. Artists who post 3–5 times a week grow faster than artists who post once and wait for magic to happen.

05 UNDERSTAND THE ALGORITHM

The algorithm is not your enemy — it is just a tool watching listener behavior. It does not care who you know or how much money you spent. It only cares what real people do when they hear your song.

Saves	How many people save your song to their library — this is one of the strongest signals of all
Completion rate	How many people listen to the whole song instead of skipping early
Skip rate	How fast people skip away — a weak intro is usually the cause
Playlist adds	How often people add your song to their own playlists
Share rate	How often people send the song to someone else

HOW TO IMPROVE EACH SIGNAL

- Make sure your song hooks the listener in the first 10 seconds
- Ask listeners directly to save the song, not just stream it
- Never buy fake streams — it tanks your completion rate and breaks the algorithm's trust in you
- Keep releasing consistently — the algorithm builds a clearer picture of your sound with every release

One highly engaged fan who saves your song and adds it to their own playlist is worth more to the algorithm than a thousand passive plays from a bot.

06 TURN LISTENERS INTO FANS

A listener presses play when your song comes on. A fan seeks your music out, shares it without being asked, and tells their friends about you. Streams can fade. Real fans stay.

BUILD AN EMAIL LIST

Social media platforms don't belong to you. They can change their rules any day. Your email list is yours forever — nobody can take it away.

REAL STORY

Musician Matthew Ebel makes a living from his music. Just 40 of his most loyal fans — not thousands, just 40 — made up over a quarter of his entire income, mostly through a small monthly membership. He didn't need to be famous. He needed a small group of people who truly cared, and a way to stay in touch with them.

That's the idea behind "1,000 true fans" — you don't need millions of listeners. You need a smaller group of real fans who show up for you, again and again.

- Use a free tool like Mailchimp to collect emails
- Give people a reason to join — a free unreleased song, or early access to new music
- Email your list every time you release something — don't wait for a "big enough" reason

GIVE YOUR FANS A HOME

A free Discord server gives your most loyal fans a place to talk to each other and to you. Even a small, active group of 100 people can create real momentum. You can also build a small "street team" — your 10 to 20 most engaged fans, who get early access and shout-outs in exchange for helping you share new music.

07 PROMOTE WITHOUT BIG MONEY

You do not need a big budget to grow. You need to spend small amounts of money, and time, in the right places.

MICRO-INFLUENCERS

Creators with 1,000 to 50,000 followers are often the sweet spot. Their audiences are engaged, they're easier to reach than big names, and many are genuinely excited to discover new music. Message them personally, offer your song for free, and never pay for fake enthusiasm.

BLOGS AND PRESS

Small, niche music blogs still send real, targeted listeners your way — often more than a big outlet would. Search "[your genre] music blog submit music" to find ones accepting new artists.

SMART AD SPEND

\$0	Free Spotify editorial pitch, SubmitHub's free daily credits, genre-specific online communities
\$10–\$25	SubmitHub paid credits, or boosting a TikTok post that's already doing well organically
\$25–\$50	A small Meta ad promoting a Reel to a genre-and-age targeted audience

08 TEAM UP WITH OTHER ARTISTS

A collaboration is one of the fastest ways to grow. When two artists team up, each one gets introduced to the other's entire fanbase. Done right — with artists at a similar level — it can double your reach quickly.

- Look for artists with a similar stream count and follower size — avoid huge mismatches
- Try complementary genres that feel fresh together, not identical ones
- You don't need a full song to collaborate — swapping playlist adds, sharing each other's Stories, or a joint live session all count
- When asking for a feature on someone else's song, come with a clear idea — a hook, a verse, or a production suggestion

09 LEARN FROM YOUR NUMBERS

After every release, open your Spotify for Artists dashboard. You're looking for two simple things: how many people saved the song, and where your streams actually came from — playlists, TikTok, search, or your own posts.

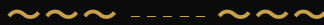
Whatever worked best, do more of it next time. Whatever didn't work, drop it. That's the whole game — release, watch, adjust, repeat.

FREE & LOW-COST TOOLS

Pre-save links	DistroKid HyperFollow, Linkfire, Feature.fm
Email list	Mailchimp, ConvertKit
Playlist outreach	SubmitHub, Groover
Analytics	Spotify for Artists, Apple Music for Artists

YOUR SIMPLE ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Profile photo, bio, and links are all set up on Spotify, Apple Music, and Amazon Music
- ☐ Pre-save link created and shared 2–3 weeks before release
- ☐ At least 10 independent playlist pitches sent
- ☐ 3–5 TikTok or Reels posts made per week
- ☐ Email list set up with a simple sign-up reward
- ☐ One low-cost promotion tried this release (\$0–\$50)
- ☐ One possible collaborator reached out to
- ☐ Streams and saves checked and reviewed after each release



STRATEGY BEFORE STREAMS

This guide was written for the Fineboy Producer community — independent artists building something real, one strategic release at a time.

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